AI Policy as Pedagogy

Co-developing AI course policy with students
Parsa Rajabi, UBC | AI-cademy 2026

Licence and citation

You're welcome to use, share, and adapt this material for your course. Please include the citation below and note any changes you make. CC BY 4.0

Rajabi, P. (2026). AI Policy as Pedagogy: Co-developing AI course policy with students. AI-cademy 2026, University of British Columbia. Workshop resource page

---

Workshop materials

Workshop slides | Miro board | tiny.cc/aicademy-miro

Bring this activity to your class

Think of a time a student asked you, "Can I use AI for this?" What were they working on, and what did you want them to learn by doing it? That question is a good starting point for a scenario card.

You're welcome to use our Miro board and adapt any of the four cards we picked for this workshop. I'd encourage you to write a few of your own, too. Your students will have more to say about a scenario when they recognize the assignment and can picture themselves making that decision.

Learning objectives

By the end of the workshop, you'll be able to:

- Explain how an assessment's learning goal shapes which AI uses make sense.
- Evaluate an AI use scenario and justify whether it's 🟢 green, 🟡 yellow, or 🔴 red.
- Write a yellow condition a student can apply while working on an assignment.
- Plan how to involve students in developing your course AI policy.

Before class, choose your scenarios

Pick one upcoming assessment and think about a decision students will face while working on it. To turn that decision into a card, describe what the student has already done and what they want AI to do next. For a follow-up question, change one detail and ask whether it changes their reasoning.

Here's what that could look like in two disciplines:

- Statistics. "I chose a statistical test and ran it myself. Can I ask AI to check my interpretation of the results?" What if you asked AI to choose the test for you?
- History. "I drafted an argument using two primary sources. Can I ask AI to flag a claim that needs more evidence?" What if you asked AI to write the argument from those same sources?

You can put your cards on a copy of the Miro board or print them for an in-person discussion.

The four cards we picked for the workshop

1. Studying. You give AI your lecture notes and ask it to turn them into flashcards. You try to answer each question before flipping the card over.
2. A graded assignment. You use AI to create part of your submission. You can explain, check, and change everything it produced on your own. Given the time you had, though, you probably wouldn't have produced that part yourself.
3. Writing. You draft an explanation and ask AI to flag places where a reader might get lost. You revise it yourself. Would you choose the same colour if AI rewrote the paragraph for you?
4. Presenting. You draw a diagram showing how a campus printer decides whose document to print next. While you practise explaining it, you ask AI to play the audience and ask you questions. Would your answer change if AI wrote your speaking notes?

Run the activity in 15 minutes

1. Set the context (2 min)

Tell students which assessment you have in mind and what you want them to learn. Be clear about which course requirements are already set and which decisions students can help make.

Model one card together. "You've spent 20 minutes on an assignment and you're stuck. Can you ask AI for a hint?" One possible answer is 🟡 yellow. "You can ask for a hint if you can explain what you've tried and where you got stuck."

2. Discuss in pairs or trios (8 min)

Ask each group to pick a frame on the Miro board and mark it In use. For each card, talk through the scenario, keep the colour your group picked, and delete the other two boxes. On paper, circle your choice.

- 🟢 Green means this use is allowed.
- 🟡 Yellow means this use is allowed under specific conditions.
- 🔴 Red means this use is not allowed.

If your group picks yellow, say the condition out loud. Would another student know whether they could use AI before they started? On the workshop board, groups that finish early can try the extra cards on the left.

3. Compare decisions (5 min)

For the workshop, we picked Card 2 to open the discussion. In your own class, choose a card that groups saw differently. Ask, “Which colour did you pick? What did you think the assignment was assessing?”

Invite two groups to explain their reasoning. Before you move on, write down one condition they proposed and read it back. Ask, “If this were in the assignment instructions, would you know what you could do?”

Turn the discussion into course policy

Use the assessment and one of the conditions your students proposed to draft a short policy together.

- Learning goal. “On this assignment, you’ll demonstrate ___ by ___.”
- Fixed rules. What does the course already require or prohibit? Explain why.
- Student input. Where did students suggest different approaches? Which one will the class use, and why?
- Yellow condition. “For ___, you may use AI to ___ only if ___.”
- Disclosure. If students use AI, what should they record, and where should they put it?

Share the draft and ask, “Did I capture what we agreed on? Is there anything you’d still be unsure about when you start the assignment?” Give students who missed the activity a chance to weigh in, then publish the final wording where students will look for it. Revisit it mid-term and ask which parts were clear once they actually used it.

A personal AI policy for students

Ask students to pick one upcoming assignment and finish these sentences for themselves, keeping the course policy in mind.

- 🟢 I'll use AI for ___ because ___.
- 🟡 I'll use AI for ___ only if ___.
- 🔴 I'll do ___ myself because I want to practise ___.

After they submit, ask them to look back at what they wrote. "What would you keep or change for the next assignment, and why?"

Licence and citation

You're welcome to use, share, and adapt this material for your course. Please include the citation below and note any changes you make. CC BY 4.0

Rajabi, P. (2026). AI Policy as Pedagogy: Co-developing AI course policy with students. AI-cademy 2026, University of British Columbia. Workshop resource page